

# Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

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# Lacerte Application Support

Scope: Lacerte Application

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## 1. Purpose

This SOP defines the end-to-end process for supporting the Intuit Lacerte Tax Application used for business tax return preparation. It provides detailed guidance for application access management, user onboarding/offboarding, role assignment, troubleshooting, and escalation to ensure secure, consistent, and uninterrupted operations.

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## 2. Scope

This SOP applies to:

- IT Service Desk / ROC Engineers (L1/L2)
- Application Administrators
- L3 / Vendor Support Coordination
- HR and Business Stakeholders (request initiation)

It covers:

- Lacerte access eligibility
  - Admin and user account creation via Intuit ProConnect
  - Application login and usage support
  - Common issues (including S-Corporation access issues)
  - Incident handling, RCA, and escalation
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## 3. Application Overview

- Application Name: Intuit Lacerte Tax

- Usage: Business tax returns (S-Corp, C-Corp, Partnerships, etc.)
  - Platform: Server-based (accessed via RDP/VM)
  - User Authentication: Intuit account via ProConnect
  - Password Behavior:
    - Same username and password across Lacerte versions (2016–2024)
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## 4. Roles & Responsibilities

### 4.1 HR / Business Team

- Initiates onboarding/offboarding requests
- Clearly specifies required application access:
  - Drake (Individual Tax)
  - Lacerte (Business Tax)
  - Or both

### 4.2 IT Service Desk / ROC (L1/L2)

- Validate request approvals
- Perform user onboarding/offboarding
- Provide first-level troubleshooting
- Coordinate with L3/vendor where required

### 4.3 Lacerte Application Admin

- Manage users in Intuit ProConnect
- Assign appropriate roles
- Grant entity-level permissions (S-Corp, etc.)

### 4.4 Vendor / L3 Support

- Resolve application-level or licensing issues
  - Support complex permission or data-related problems
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## 5. Access Eligibility Guidelines

| Employee Role                      | Required Access |
|------------------------------------|-----------------|
| Individual Tax Preparer            | Drake only      |
| Business Tax Preparer              | Lacerte only    |
| Mixed Role (Individual + Business) | Drake + Lacerte |

Note: Not all employees require Lacerte access. Approx. 60% may require both, while ~40% may need only Drake.

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## 6. User Onboarding – Lacerte Access

### 6.1 Pre-Requisites

- Approved access request from HR/business
  - Confirmed role (Business / Mixed)
  - Valid official email ID
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### 6.2 Creating User in Intuit ProConnect

1. Open browser and log in to Intuit ProConnect using Admin credentials.
2. Navigate to:
  - My Account → Global Value Add → Manage Users
3. Click Add User.
4. Enter:
  - First Name
  - Last Name
  - Official Email ID
5. Assign Role:
  - Company Admin (only for IT/Admin users)

- Standard – All Access (for end users)

6. Send Invite.

The user will receive an email invite from Intuit.

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## 6.3 User Invitation Acceptance (End User Steps)

1. User opens Intuit invitation email.
  2. Clicks Accept Invite.
  3. Creates Intuit account password.
  4. Enters:
    - First Name & Last Name (as created or personal – both accepted)
    - Mobile number (OTP verification required)
  5. Account setup completes.
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## 7. Lacerte Application Login (Server)

1. User logs into assigned server/VM.
  2. Launch Lacerte (Year-specific version, e.g., 2024).
  3. Login using:
    - Intuit Email ID
    - Intuit Password
  4. Verify application opens successfully.
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## 8. S-Corporation (S-Corp) Access – Critical SOP

### 8.1 Issue Description

- Users with Standard – All Access role cannot open S-Corp clients by default.
  - Only Company Admin can open S-Corp unless explicit rights are assigned.
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## 8.2 User Communication (Mandatory)

Upon onboarding, IT must inform the user:

“Please check if you are able to access S-Corporation clients in Lacerte. If not, inform IT immediately.”

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## 8.3 Granting S-Corp Rights

1. Login to Lacerte as Admin.
  2. Navigate to:
    - Settings → Primary Options → Trustee Rights
  3. Locate the affected username.
  4. Assign permissions:
    - All required rights
    - Exclude:
      - Primary Options
      - E-Filing (if not required)
  5. Save changes.
  6. Ask user to relaunch Lacerte and test S-Corp access.
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# 9. Common Issues & Troubleshooting

## 9.1 User Cannot Login to Lacerte

- Verify Intuit invite acceptance
- Reset Intuit password
- Confirm correct Lacerte version

## 9.2 Application Opens but No Clients Visible

- Check tax type filters
- Validate entity permissions

## 9.3 S-Corp Client Not Opening

- Confirm user role (Standard vs Admin)
- Assign Trustee Rights as per Section 8

## 9.4 Server / Path Errors

- Validate RDP access
  - Confirm shared path permissions
  - Restart Lacerte services if required
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# 10. Lacerte Vendor Support & Contact Details

## 10.1 Accessing Lacerte Support from Application

Lacerte provides built-in vendor support access through the application interface. All engineers **must use this method as the primary and preferred channel** for contacting Intuit Lacerte Support, as it ensures automatic firm authentication and faster case routing.

### Navigation:

1. Log in to the Lacerte application on the assigned server/VM.
2. Ensure the correct tax year version (e.g., Lacerte 2023/2024) is opened.
3. From the top menu bar, click Search.
4. Select Contact Us from the dropdown.
5. The application will display the RingCentral Support Contact Number mapped to the firm's registered profile.
6. Use this number to connect directly with Intuit Lacerte Support.

Note: Calling Intuit using external or generic numbers may lead to extended verification, incorrect routing, or call rejection.

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## 10.2 Registered Firm & Account Details

The following firm information is permanently registered with Intuit Lacerte and is used for caller verification, license validation, and entitlement checks. These details must be referenced accurately during support interactions.

| Field               | Details                  |
|---------------------|--------------------------|
| Firm                | GLOBALCFO                |
| Customer ID         | 400672108                |
| Firm Name           | GLOBALCFO                |
| Federal ID (Fed ID) | 87-1232525               |
| Street Address      | 4512 Legacy DR, Unit 100 |
| City                | Plano                    |
| State               | TX                       |
| ZIP Code            | 75024                    |
| Telephone Number    | 888-482-0279             |
| EFIN                | 759351                   |
| ERO Contact         | Sandeep Shroff           |

#### Usage Rules:

- These details must not be altered in any internal or vendor communication
- Use the information strictly for verification purposes when requested by Intuit
- Do not proactively disclose sensitive identifiers unless prompted

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### 10.3 Types of Issues to Escalate to Intuit Lacerte Support

Engineers should escalate issues to Intuit Lacerte Support only after completing internal troubleshooting. Typical vendor-escalation scenarios include:

- License activation or validation failures
- Product entitlement or module access issues
- E-file transmission or IRS/State rejection errors
- Application crashes with repeatable error codes
- Database corruption or data integrity issues
- Year-to-year data conversion failures
- Lacerte updates or hotfix installation failures

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## 10.4 Pre-Call Checklist

Before contacting Intuit Lacerte Support, the engineer must ensure the following information is available:

- Firm Name and Customer ID
- Affected Lacerte tax year/version
- Username experiencing the issue
- Exact error message or screenshot
- Steps already attempted internally
- Business impact (number of users / returns blocked)

Failure to provide this information may result in call deferral or case closure by Intuit.

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## 10.5 During the Support Call

- Clearly explain the issue in business and technical terms
- Follow Intuit's troubleshooting steps live on the call
- Avoid making configuration changes without understanding rollback steps
- Request clarification for any permanent or destructive action

Ensure that the following are captured:

- Intuit Case Number
  - Support Engineer Name
  - Summary of actions performed
  - Recommended next steps or follow-up timelines
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## 10.6 Post-Call Actions & Documentation

After the support call:

1. Update the ITSM ticket with:
  - Intuit Case Number
  - Root cause (if identified)

- Actions taken
  - Pending follow-ups
2. Inform the affected user(s) of progress or resolution
  3. If the issue is recurring, initiate an RCA and preventive action plan
  4. Attach screenshots, logs, or call summaries to the ticket for audit purposes
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## 10.7 Security, Compliance & Audit Controls

- Customer ID, EFIN, and Fed ID are confidential identifiers
  - Do not store these details in unsecured documents or chats
  - Access to vendor communication must be limited to authorized IT staff
  - All vendor interactions are audit-relevant and must be traceable via ticketing systems
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## 11. Offboarding – Lacerte Access Removal

1. Receive HR-approved offboarding request.
  2. Login to Intuit ProConnect.
  3. Navigate to Manage Users.
  4. Remove or deactivate user.
  5. Confirm access removal.
  6. Document completion in ticket.
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## 12. Security & Compliance

- Do not share passwords via chat/email
  - Use OTP-based verification only
  - Maintain least-privilege access
  - Periodically review admin accounts
-

## 13. Escalation Matrix

| Level | Responsibility             |
|-------|----------------------------|
| L1    | Basic login/access issues  |
| L2    | Permissions, S-Corp access |
| L3    | Vendor / Intuit escalation |

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## 14. Documentation & Audit

- Maintain ticket records for:
    - User creation
    - Permission changes
    - Access removal
  - Capture RCA for recurring issues
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## 14. Revision & Ownership

- Document Owner: IT Service Delivery Manager
  - Review Cycle: Quarterly or on major application change
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